



Code of Conduct

Our Community Values

Rising Tide is a community built on respect, safety, and shared purpose. All members, volunteers, officers, and guests are expected to uphold these values at every meeting, event, and online space connected to the organization.

Respect and Inclusion

Everyone deserves to feel welcome and valued. All officers, members, and guests shall be accepted as they present themselves. Harassment, discrimination, bullying, or hostile behavior is not permitted. Members are expected to treat one another with kindness and respect.

Safe Community Spaces

Meetings and events must remain safe for all participants. Behavior that threatens the physical or emotional safety of others will not be tolerated. Concerns may be reported to the Chair, Vice Chair, or any officer and will be handled discreetly.

Privacy and Confidentiality

Personal information shared within Rising Tide is not to be shared outside the group without consent. Photos or videos of members should only be taken or posted with permission. People may present differently in meetings than they do in public, and their presentation within Rising Tide is to be treated as private. If members encounter one another outside the group, they must respect the individual's public presentation and never disclose or imply anything that could out them or reveal aspects of their identity they have not chosen to share publicly.

Constructive Participation

Members are expected to participate in ways that support the mission and allow everyone to be heard. Each person deserves the opportunity to speak without interruption. Repeated interruptions or behavior that prevents others from participating respectfully may result in the individual being asked to step outside or leave the meeting.

Digital and Online Conduct

This Code applies to all Rising Tide spaces, including online platforms, group chats, and digital communications used for organizational purposes.

Press and Public Statements

All press-related inquiries must be directed to the Chair, the Owner, or a designated press officer if one has been appointed. Members may not speak to the press on behalf of Rising Tide or NOVA unless formally authorized.

Conflicts of Interest

Members and officers should avoid situations where personal interests conflict with the interests of Rising Tide. Any potential conflict should be disclosed to the Board.

Anti-Retaliation

No member shall face retaliation for raising concerns, reporting violations, or requesting support from officers.

Accountability

Violations of this Code of Conduct may result in a conversation with an officer, a formal warning, removal from membership, or, in cases involving threats, harassment, or unlawful behavior, reporting to local authorities. The response will reflect the severity of the conduct and the need to maintain a safe and respectful community.